of all the ranks kept on loading up ass-load after ass-load of satchels full of white tankas. They also paid their soldiers for this spoil.

He returned to Kābul with added honour and of course, he was extremely happy to with the goods and treasure. His reputation had gotten highly elevated. Upon returning, Babur married (in AD 1507) his uncle Sulṭān Aḥmad Mīrzā's daughter Ma'ṣūma Sulṭān Begum. He had asked her for marriage at Khurāsān and had brought her here from there.

Shaybāni Khān at Qandahār

Within a few days after the glorious victory of Qandahār, a servant of Nāṣir Mīrzā brought bad news. Shaybāni Khān had laid siege to Qandahār. It was Muqīm who after having fled to Zamīn-dāwar went further to see Shaybāni Khān. A servant of Shāh Beg's too had been to see Shaybāni Khān. They both instigated and requested Shaybāni to come, and he didn't deny it. He swiftly entered Qandahār by the mountain road.[43] Shaybāni was also expecting to find Babur there. Perhaps this was the fear for which Qāsim Beg was insisting on Babur's exit from the vicinity of Qandahār at the earliest. For this instance, Babur has mentioned following verse in *Baburnama*:[*]

> (Persian) What a mirror shews to the young man,
>
> A baked brick shews to the old one!

Shaybāni Khān besieged Nāṣir Mīrzā in Qandahār as soon as he arrived.

The news had left people in Kābul petrified. Hearing the news Babur immediately summoned the begs for counsel. His discussion went as follows:[†]

> Strangers and ancient foes, such as are Shaybāni Khān and the Aūzbegs, are in possession of all the countries once held by Tīmūr Beg's descendants; even where Turks and Chaghatāīs survive in corners and border-lands, they have all joined the Aūzbeg, willingly or with aversion; one remains, I myself, in Kābul, the foe mightily strong, I very weak, with no means of making terms, no strength to oppose; that, in the presence of such power and potency, we had to think of some place for ourselves and, at this crisis and in the crack of time there was, to put a wider space between us and the strong foeman; that choice lay between Badakhshān and Hindustan and that decision must now be made.

Qāsim Beg and Sherīm ṭaghāī agreed for Badakhshān[44] while many other households beg including Babur preferred going towards Hindustan to accomplish an unfinished dream of Tīmūr.